

HR POLICY

Leave and Time Off Policy

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Owner	People Team	Effective date	January 1, 2026
Applies to	All employees	Next review	January 1, 2027

1. Purpose

This policy explains paid time off (PTO), holidays, sick leave, parental leave and other leave types available to Helix employees. Requests are submitted and tracked in the BambooHR portal.

2. Annual PTO Entitlement

Full-time employees accrue PTO based on years of service. Part-time employees receive a pro-rated amount.

Years of Service	Annual PTO Days
0 to less than 3 years	20 days
3 to less than 6 years	25 days
6 or more years	30 days

- PTO accrues monthly and may be used as it accrues.
- A maximum of **5 unused days** may be carried over to the next calendar year. Carried-over days expire on March 31.
- Requests for more than 3 consecutive days should be submitted at least **2 weeks** in advance. Managers must approve or decline within 3 business days.
- In the United States, unused accrued PTO is paid out on termination where required by state law.

3. Company Holidays

Helix observes **10 company holidays** per year, plus **2 floating holidays** that employees may use for cultural or personal observances. The holiday calendar for each country is published in BambooHR each December. Helix is closed between December 25 and January 1 in the US and UK offices; these days are covered by company holidays and are not deducted from PTO.

4. Sick Leave

- Employees receive **10 paid sick days** per calendar year. Sick days do not carry over.
- Notify your manager as early as possible on the first day of absence.
- A doctor's note is required after **3 or more consecutive** sick days.
- Sick leave may be used to care for an ill immediate family member.

5. Parental and Family Leave

Leave Type	Duration	Pay
Primary caregiver parental leave	16 weeks	100% of base salary
Secondary caregiver parental leave	8 weeks	100% of base salary
Adoption or foster placement	Same as parental leave	100% of base salary
Bereavement - immediate family	5 days	Paid
Bereavement - extended family	3 days	Paid
Jury duty / civic obligation	As required	Paid, up to 10 days

Parental leave may be taken in one block or split into two blocks within the first 12 months after birth or placement. Notify the People Team at least 60 days before the expected leave start date where possible.

6. Other Leave

- **Unpaid leave:** up to 12 weeks with People Team and VP approval.
- **Sabbatical:** employees with 5 or more years of service may take a 4-week paid sabbatical once every 5 years, subject to manager approval and business needs.
- **Medical leave:** handled per applicable law (for example FMLA in the United States); contact the People Team for guidance.

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